

ARIANNE MURPHY

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Award-winning strategic communications leader with 7+ years of public sector experience driving enterprise-level media relations, crisis communications, and integrated storytelling for a county of 2.5 million residents. Member of a communications team recognized by California Association of Public Information Officials (CAPIO), the California State Association of Counties (CSAC) Innovation Ward, and the Public Relations Society of America (PRSA) Polaris Awards. Currently embedded in the County Executive Office — advising the CEO, supporting the Board of Supervisors, and serving as the central hub for communications strategy across 40 county departments. Invented and leads the RivCoONE internal communications strategy, a flagship countywide culture change initiative for 23,000 employees. Demonstrated expertise applying AI tools — including Claude, ChatGPT, Copilot, and Gemini — across the full communications lifecycle to accelerate production and sharpen outcomes. Analytics-driven communicator who consistently measures campaign impact through engagement metrics, open rates, reach, and performance insights to inform strategy. Proven communicator, trainer, and public speaker with a track record of rising to new challenges in fast-moving, high-accountability environments.

CORE COMPETENCIES

• AI-Augmented Communications Workflows	• External and Community Stakeholder Engagement
• Crisis & Emergency Communications	• Social Media Strategy, Monitoring, & Analytics
• Media Relations & Earned Media Strategy	• Internal Communications & Change Management
• Cross-functional and Multidisciplinary Program Leadership	• Data-Driven Storytelling & Performance Reporting
• Executive Communications & Messaging	• Video Project Management & Multimedia Content
• Content Strategy & Editorial Operations	• Governance, Compliance & Brand Integrity

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Public Information Specialist *November 2023 – Present*

County of Riverside – Executive Office | Office of the CEO
Management | Riverside, CA

★ **CAPIO Award Winner | CSAC Innovation Award Winner | PRSA Polaris Award**

- Serve as a senior communications strategist for a county of 2.5 million residents, operating directly under the County Communications Director and CEO, providing strategic guidance, approvals, and direction to communicators across 40 county departments and the Board of Supervisors.
- Work in direct collaboration to fulfill projects request, news releases, and media inquires with executive leadership including department directors and assistant chief executive officers of the county's health and human services, internal services, public works, and public safety portfolios.
- Invented and architected the RivCoONE internal communications strategy from the ground up: a countywide culture change initiative for 23,000 employees built around a no wrong door service model. Personally developed the strategy, trained all 12 cross-departmental communications professionals on goals and messaging, and serve as the sole decision-maker and direction-setter for the program.
- Deliver public speaking engagements representing the county on RivCoONE, the countywide budget campaign, and equity communications, presenting to internal staff, department leadership, and external stakeholders.

- Leverage AI tools including Claude, ChatGPT, Copilot, and Gemini to augment production of news releases, video scripts, talking points, media responses, communications plans, and social media content, improving speed, consistency, and quality across all deliverables.
- Conduct weekly media monitoring and analytics sessions- previously with Cision, currently with Meltwater- pulling traditional and social media coverage reports to track campaign performance, identify emerging narratives, analyze community sentiment and inform executive communications strategy.
- Host and lead countywide PIO meetings, presenting communications updates and strategic projects to PIOs across all 40 departments, serving as the central hub and standards-setter for county communications.
- Leads ADA-compliant website implementation in accordance with new California state law requirements, coordinating across departments and IT to ensure all county digital properties meet accessibility standards.
- Respond to special project requests from the Board of Supervisors, including communications planning for national observances, executive messaging, and high-priority county initiatives, often under tight turnaround windows.
- Oversee countywide budget communications campaign, including a resident survey deployed to 2.5 million people, leading outreach strategy, media pitching, earned media coordination, and CEO talking points.
- Draft time-sensitive media responses to countywide crises and inquiries spanning animal control, child welfare, voter rights, and public health emergencies, all subject to CEO-level review before release.
- Lead equity communications program, overseeing an internal publication spotlighting departments advancing equity and working directly with department heads to identify and elevate equity stories.
- Curate and manage social media content for the County of Riverside's official accounts, developing an employee-as-influencer strategy that activates county staff as authentic storytellers, humanizing county government and driving organic community engagement.
- Apply a metrics-first approach to all campaigns and communications projects, consistently analyzing performance through social media insights, email open rates, website views, reach, and engagement data to measure impact and refine strategy in real time.
- Support in the planning and execution of countywide events and media engagements like the State of the County and campaign press conferences.
- Participate in Rapid Improvement Events (RIEs) grounded in Lean methodology, gaining working knowledge of large-scale business process improvement and organizational transformation frameworks applied across county operations.

Public Information Specialist *May 2023 – November 2023*

Riverside University Health System – Public Health Department

Media Relations and Administration | Riverside, CA

- Reinstated department's Instagram presence, growing account from zero to nearly 1,000 followers with 2,600+ monthly interactions.
- Served in the county's Emergency Operations Center (EOC), providing communications support including content curation, video editing, social media writing, talking points, and website copy.
- Produced the department's monthly Public Health Update broadcast in partnership with RivCoTV, managing all logistics from guest identification to graphics and social distribution.
- Managed daily executive communications needs, crisis communications planning, and media inquiries from reporters seeking statements from program directors and public health physicians.
- Utilized Zencity to monitor traditional and social media coverage across public health campaigns, analyzing community sentiment, engagement trends, and media reach to guide communications decisions and departmental reporting.
- Scripted, recorded, and edited video content including graphics and lower thirds for departmental programs and executive presentations.

Marketing, Media & Communications Coordinator *June 2022 – May 2023*

Riverside University Health System – Public Health Department

Media Relations and Administration | Riverside, CA

- Led all communications for the Monkeypox (MPOX) and respiratory illness emergency response, managing content creation, editing, publishing, and task delegation for all education and awareness materials.
- Designed and launched the department's first-ever mobile advertising campaign on dating apps for MPOX awareness, generating over 50,000 unique impressions and 6,000+ website visits.
- Reported tri-weekly to MPOX/respiratory illness EOC leadership on social media analytics, trends, and community engagement, providing standby strategic communications support.
- Drafted the department's social media policy, strategic crisis communications plan, and streamlined intake forms for staff video, marketing, and newsletter requests.
- Provided technical communications assistance to 21+ public health programs on content creation, digital outreach, and promotional campaigns.
- Supervised interns and temporary staff; facilitated social media strategy consultations with the executive team.

Public Health Communications – Health Communications Assistant II*April 2019 – June 2022*

Riverside University Health System – Tobacco Control Project (TCP)

Nutrition and Health Promotion Branch | Riverside, CA

- Strategized, planned, and managed paid media campaigns across OOH, digital, and radio for all TCP project objectives, serving as primary agency liaison.
- Developed and budgeted integrated communications plans for earned and paid media; managed RFP process for media-buy contracts.
- Hosted community focus groups to test website designs and campaign materials; presented findings and mock-ups to branch leadership for executive approval.
- Trained TCP staff on editorial writing including LTEs, op-eds, press releases, and media advisories; led presentations to community groups including schools, faith communities, and civic organizations.
- Tracked and reported website analytics to the California Tobacco Control Project (CTCP).

Public Health Communications – WIC Program (Concurrent)*January 2020 – June 2022*

Riverside University Health System – WIC Program

Nutrition and Health Promotion Branch | Riverside, CA

- Developed social media and digital strategies for the Public Health EOC during COVID-19, supporting county PIOs with crisis messaging.
- Managed WIC social media accounts; supervised a team of one staff and two interns for content creation and campaign execution.
- Grew WIC Facebook following from 400 to 522 and Instagram from 40 to 85 in two weeks through targeted content strategy.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Public Administration | Minor: Communication

California State University, Fresno | 2012 – 2017

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

2023 Media Relations & Intermediate Public Information Officer Certification, Cal OES / California Specialized Training Institute

2023 Graphic Design and Promotional Printing, Riverside Community College

2021 Writing and Editing Specialization, University of Michigan

In Progress AI Fundamentals, Anthropic (Claude)

AI TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

• Claude (Anthropic)	• SharePoint / Microsoft 365
• ChatGPT / GPT-4 (OpenAI)	• GovDelivery
• Copilot, Teams, Powerpoint (Microsoft Suite)	• HootSuite / Sprout Social
• Google Gemini	• WordPress / CMS platforms
• Canva / Visme	• Meltwater / Cision / Zencity
• Adobe Creative Suite	• Notion / Asana